

June 12th, 2026
Week 24
Volume 282, Issue 1239

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

*"Now this is not the end. It is not even the beginning of the end.
But it is, perhaps, the end of the beginning."*

- Winston Churchill

Highlights:

- Strikes pause.
- Premium cracks.
- Freight cools.
- Monsoon rules.

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-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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PREMIUM CRACKS, PEN HOVERS

The war premium has finally cracked. Brent crude fell more than 4% on Thursday toward USD 89 per barrel, its lowest level since March, with WTI near USD 86, after President Trump suspended military strikes against Iran that had been scheduled for that evening and told reporters that a deal reopening the Strait of Hormuz could be signed as early as this weekend, likely in Europe. Iran's semi-official Fars news agency reported that Tehran is likely to approve the agreement, though no final text has been confirmed by either side. The Weekly first reported the war premium cracking in Week 15. Nine weeks later, the premium has finally read the report.

The pen is hovering, not yet landed. The week that produced the breakthrough also produced US strikes on Iranian radar and drone sites on June 10 and Iranian missile responses across the Gulf, with mediation now running through Qatar and draft texts still being exchanged. The framework requires Iran to clear all mines from Hormuz within 30 days of signature and bars tolls on the strait, while even a signed deal faces idled production fields, damaged export facilities, and the slow mechanics of restoring confidence to a waterway that has spent a quarter as a war zone. The agreement could be signed this weekend, in Europe, which is at least a new continent for the deadline to miss.

Freight has cooled for the first time in the arc. The Baltic Dry Index eased to 2,818 on June 9 from the June 1 peak of 3,222, with the Baltic Capesize Index at 4,441 and daily Capesize earnings at USD 40,274, down from the USD 49,511 high of the prior week, though Supramax and Handysize both firmed. For the first time since February, the two forces that have kept older tonnage trading rather than beaching, the bunker-cost floor and the freight earnings premium, are softening in the same week. They have chosen the week the beach is closed for the season. The market's timing remains undefeated.

May inflation prints have landed across the basin, and the pattern is uniform: annual rates climbing on accumulated base effects even as the monthly shocks fade. Pakistan's May CPI rose to 11.7%, the highest since June 2024, yet monthly inflation collapsed to 0.5% from 2.5%. Turkey's May CPI edged to 32.61% while its monthly pace fell to 1.71% from 4.18%. The fire is going out at the stove while the smoke alarm still rings. Currencies extended their repair: the Indian Rupee held its recovery near 95.40, the Pakistani Rupee sustained its 2026 best at approximately 278.39, the Bangladeshi Taka held the floor of its band at 122.75, and the Turkish Lira steadied near its record at approximately 45.85. Detailed country reads follow on pages 2 through 5.

The monsoon now rules the beaching calendar regardless of what is signed in Europe this weekend. But the shape of the next chapter is forming: if the pen lands, the 30-day de-mining clock starts, the strait normalises through July, the bunker floor and freight premium continue to deflate, and the tonnage that nine weeks of war could not release begins to face the question the war deferred. The first chapter of this arc recorded one unbroken fact: the ships did not come. The second chapter opens with the first credible reason to believe they eventually will, arriving, as everything in this market has arrived, precisely when the beach cannot take them. The premium cracks. The pen hovers. The monsoon rules.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 24 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

**BAND HOLDS, BEACH RESTS**

Band holds.

Bangladesh enters Week 24 with USD/BDT at approximately 122.75, holding the floor of the 122.74 to 123.18 band that has now contained the Taka through the entire conflict and into the monsoon without a single breach. The Brent collapse toward USD 89, the broad dollar easing on the deal hopes, and the Pakistani Rupee's sustained strength have all passed through the week without testing the band in either direction. Foreign exchange reserves near USD 34.12 billion remain the operative buffer, and the central bank's management task continues to shrink as the global risk premium deflates. Local steel plate prices held steady at BDT 65,000 per ton, with the USD equivalent near USD 535 per ton, as mill-level easing tracked the Brent break.

Beach rests.

Chattogram has settled into the monsoon pattern, with beaching cycles reduced and the plot operators working down the tonnage delivered through the late-May tide windows. The Letter of Credit pipeline remains fully permissive, a configuration that now simply waits for the supply side of the market to produce something to finance. The Bangladesh May CPI release from BBS is the operative watch item in the coming days; the April print at 9.04% remains the reference, and the Pakistan and Turkey May reads suggest the annual rate may drift up on base effects even as the monthly energy shock fades with Brent below USD 90.

Q3 forms.

The shape of Bangladesh's third quarter is beginning to form around the diplomatic calendar. If the framework is signed this weekend and the 30-day de-mining clause runs, the strait normalises through July, the bunker-cost floor that kept older tonnage trading continues to deflate, and the freight premium has already begun to ease from its June 1 peak. Chattogram enters that scenario with the basin's strongest demand position: full plot capacity, cleared financing, the most resilient currency band in the region, and pricing that holds above Alang and Aliaga at the ton level. The monsoon governs the next eight weeks. The deal, if it lands, governs everything after. For the first time since February, the second half looks better than the first.

INDIA



RUPEE STEADIES, RAINS RULE

USD/INR has held its recovery into a fourth consecutive week at approximately 95.40, consolidating the retreat from the 96.97 record of May 21. The Reserve Bank of India's June 5 hold at 5.25%, the scrapping of capital gains tax on foreign investment in government bonds, and now the Brent collapse toward USD 89 have together given the rupee its most supportive configuration since the war opened. India's import bill, exposed on roughly 70% of crude and 90% of LPG routing through or near Hormuz, is repricing in real time as the strait's traffic recovers and the war premium deflates. The currency that spent the war as Asia's worst performer now has, for the first time, a fundamental tailwind rather than a speculative one.

Rupee steadies.

The relief remains conditional on a signature that has not yet been produced. The RBI's own revised projections, retail inflation at 5.1% for FY2026-27 and growth trimmed to 6.6%, were set against the energy shock as it stood in early June, and a durable Brent settlement below USD 90 would materially improve both. Foreign institutional investors remained net sellers through early June, and the framework's unresolved questions, the 30-day de-mining clock, the idled fields, the damaged export terminals, stand between the weekend's possible signature and the normalised flows the rupee is beginning to price. The 96.97 record has receded. It has not been repealed.

Relief conditional.

Local steel plate prices at Alang softened from INR 38,500 to INR 38,000 through the week, briefly touching INR 37,800, with the USD equivalent easing from approximately USD 405 to USD 398 per ton, the Brent break feeding through to mill sentiment. India remains the lowest-priced sub-continent destination, with the gap to Pakistan near USD 295 per LDT. The monsoon governs Alang's operational calendar for the next eight weeks, and the arrival of the Sohar LNG and the late-May deliveries represent working inventory rather than a turn in candidate flow. The structural picture entering Q3 is the most constructive of the year: a recovering rupee, a deflating bunker floor, an easing freight premium, and a compliance footprint of more than 110 valid Statements of Compliance waiting for the tonnage the peace may finally release. The rains rule the present. The signature, if it comes, rules what follows.

Rains rule.



CPI CLIMBS, RUPEE SHRUGS

CPI climbs.

Pakistan's May CPI printed at 11.7% year-on-year, up from 10.9% in April and the highest reading since June 2024, with transport at plus 36.8% (versus 29.9%) and housing and utilities elevated at 16.8%. The headline is the war shock's full accumulation in the annual series. The composition tells the more important story: monthly inflation collapsed to 0.5% from April's 2.5%, the Sensitive Price Indicator's month-on-month pace eased to 0.7%, and the Wholesale Price Index declined 0.8% on the month. The annual rate is climbing on base effects while the underlying shock decelerates sharply. The smoke alarm rings loudest after the fire has begun to go out.

Rupee shrugs.

USD/PKR held at approximately 278.39 through the print, sustaining its strongest level of 2026 and extending the rupee's standing as the only sub-continent currency to have appreciated against the dollar across the entire conflict. The FX market has looked through the 11.7% headline to the 0.5 % monthly pace and the Brent collapse that will feed the June print, and has concluded the State Bank's 100 basis point hike to 11.5% has the trajectory contained. With the weekly oil import bill that Prime Minister Sharif quantified at USD 800 million now deflating alongside Brent, the external account stress that defined the April shock is unwinding at its source. The currency's verdict on the inflation print was to ignore it.

Clock starts.

Local steel plate prices at PKR 195,000 per ton held, with the USD equivalent near USD 700 per ton on the firm rupee. Gadani's absolute pricing remains the firmest of the year, the gap to India is near USD 295 per LDT, and the arrival of the Ron at 21,502 LDT marks the largest unit Gadani has received since the war opened. The strategic clock, flagged last week, is now visibly running: each tanker that transits Hormuz under US coordination erodes a little more of the Gulf proximity premium that anchored Gadani's wartime advantage. A signed deal with a 30-day de-mining clause would set that erosion on a schedule. Pakistan consolidated the war quarter better than any destination in the basin. The peace quarter will test how much of that consolidation was structural and how much was circumstantial.

TURKEY

INFLATION CREEPS, LIRA WAITS



Turkey's May CPI printed at 32.61% year-on-year, up from 32.37% in April and slightly above expectations of 32.5%, the highest reading since October 2025. As in Pakistan, the monthly composition softened materially: consumer prices rose 1.71% on the month, down sharply from April's 4.18% and the weakest monthly increase since December. Food and non-alcoholic beverages rose to 34.86% annually, while housing eased slightly to 45.59% and transport to 34.29%. The Istanbul Chamber's parallel series for the city printed 36.8%. The annual rate creeps higher on arithmetic. The monthly pulse, for the first time since the war opened, is fading.

Inflation creeps.

The Central Bank of Turkey has suspended its year-end inflation forecast range outright, citing "a period of high uncertainty," while maintaining a 24% year-end target and tightening liquidity by shifting funding to the 40% overnight lending rate. The suspension of the forecast range is the institution's most candid admission of the year: the controlled-disinflation framework that the war's energy shock overran in April cannot yet be re-anchored. USD/TRY steadied near 45.85, just off the 45.90 record, as the broad dollar eased. The Brent collapse toward USD 89, if sustained through a signed deal, is the disinflation tailwind the TCMB has waited for all year. The bank has stopped forecasting whether it will arrive. It is waiting, like everyone else, on the pen.

Framework strained.

At USD 268 to USD 290 per LDT across vessel types, Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage, with the gaps to Pakistan and Bangladesh unbridgeable and the gap to India steady on the rupee's consolidation. Turkey's relevance remains confined to the EU-regulated tonnage segment, where Basel Convention compliance overrides price. The prospective flood of post-war tonnage, when it comes, will route overwhelmingly to the sub-continent on the price differential, and Aliaga's share of it will be set by regulation rather than by markets. That was true through the war. It will remain true through the peace.

Niche persists.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 24 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	Steady	460-465 / LDT	480-485 / LDT	490-495 / LDT
2	Pakistan	Firming	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
3	India	Steady	420-425 / LDT	440-445 / LDT	450-455 / LDT
4	Turkey	Softening	268-270 / LDT	278-280 / LDT	288-290 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *Ship recycling at Alang has saved approximately **124.5 million barrels of oil**, equivalent to nearly **19.8 billion litres of crude oil**.*
- *Ship recycling at Alang has saved approximately **44.4 billion kWh of energy**, enough to power around 40 million average households for one year.*
- *The carbon emissions avoided through ship recycling at Alang are equivalent to the carbon absorbed by approximately **330 million trees growing for a decade**.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
June 26 – Muharram	June 12 – June 20 June 27 – July 05

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
June 26 – Ashura	June 14 – June 17 June 30 – July 03

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
June 26 – Muharram	July 15 - Democracy and National Unity Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of June 12, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Sohar LNG	33,003	LNG Carrier	<i>Delivered June 10</i>
2	Stolt Innovation	12,940	Chemical Tanker	Arrived June 10
3	Grouse Arrow	11,059	General Cargo	Arrived June 10
4	Gala	6,378	RoRo	Arrived June 10
5	Timon	27,063	Container	Arrived June 09

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of June 12, 2026

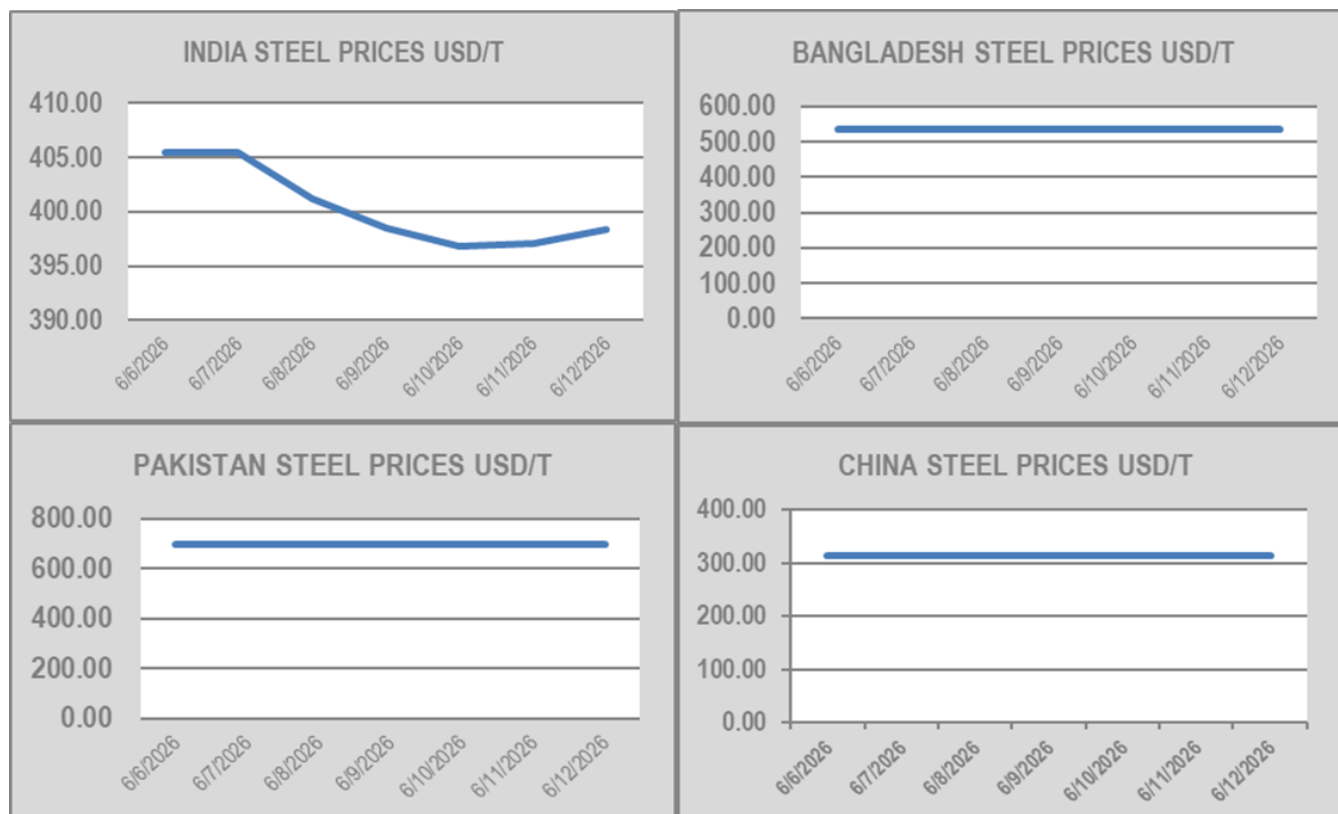
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Dong	2,372	General Cargo	<i>Delivered June 12</i>
2	Gas Crusader	1,526	Tanker	Arrived June 10
3	Kanishka	10,026	Bulk Carrier	Arrived June 09
4	Maymei	9,728	Chemical Tanker	Revert

GADANI - Port Position as of June 12, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ron	21,502	Bulk Carrier	Arrived June 01

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
6/6/2026	405.48	38,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/7/2026	405.48	38,500.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/8/2026	401.21	38,400.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/9/2026	398.53	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/10/2026	396.77	37,800.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/11/2026	397.03	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66
6/12/2026	398.32	38,000.00	696.43	195,000.00	534.98	65,000.00	314.66



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